Thomas Edison lit up the world with his invention of the electric light. Without him, the world might be a dark place. However, the electric light was not his only invention. He also invented the phonograph, the motion picture camera, and over 1,200 other things. About every two weeks, he created something new.

The Edisons moved to Michigan when Thomas was seven. Surprisingly, he attended school for only two months. His mother, a former teacher, taught him a few things, but Thomas was mostly self-educated. His natural curiosity led **him** to start experimenting at a young age with electrical things at home.

When he was 12 years old, he got his first job. He became a newsboy on a train that ran between Port Huron and Detroit. He set up a laboratory in a baggage car of the train to continue his experiments in his spare time. Unfortunately, his first work experience did not end well. Thomas lost his job when he accidentally set fire to the floor of the baggage car.

Thomas, then, worked for five years on a telegraph operator, but he continued to spend much of his time conducting experiments. He got his first patent in 1868 for a vote recorder run by electricity. In 1870, he sold another invention, a stock-ticker, for $40,000. A stock-ticker is a machine that automatically prints stock prices on a tape. He was then able to build his first shop in New Jersey.

Edison was handicapped, he was totally deaf in one ear and hard hearing in the other, but he thought of his deafness as a blessing in many ways. It kept conversations short so that he could have more time for work. He called himself a “two-shift man” because he worked 16 out of 24 hours. Edison died at the age of 84 on October 18th, 1931, in New Jersey. He left numerous inventions **that** improved the quality of life all over the world.

**I. COMPREHENSION: (15 POINTS)**

BASE YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT.

**A. WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING WOULD BE THE BEST TITLE FOR THIS PASSAGE?** (2 pts)

1. The story of a genius
2. The story of a lazy boy
3. The story of a train boy

The best title is: ……

**B. ARE THESE SENTENCES TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY: (4 PTS)**

1. the only thing that Edison invented was the electric light.

……

……

2. Edison started his first experiment at the train baggage car.

……

……

3. Edison started working at an early age

……

……

4. Edison spent most of his time working.

……

……

**C. CHOOSE THE RIGHT ORDER OF EVENTS IN THE TEXT: (ONLY ONE SENTENCE IS CORRECT, TICK IT: √ ) (2 PTS)**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. Edison first became a telegraph operator, then became a newsboy, and finally got his patent. | …… |
| 2. Edison first became a newsboy, then became a telegraph operator, and finally got his patent. | …… |
| 3. Edison first became a newsboy, then got his patent, and finally became a telegraph operator. | …… |

**D. COMPLETE THESE SENTENCES IN YOUR OWN WORDS: (2 PTS)**

1. Edison continued his experiments on the train by ……..

……

2. The stock ticker is used for …….

……

**E. PICK OUT FROM THE TEXT EXPRESSIONS OR PHRASES WHICH SHOW THAT: (3 PTS)**

1. Edison didn't spend a long time at school. (Paragraph 2)

……

2. His first job experience was not a success. (Paragraph 3)

……

3. Edison considered his deafness in a positive way. (Paragraph. 5)

……

**F. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS REFER TO IN THE TEXT? (2 PTS)**

1. him: ……

2. that: ……

# KEY AND MARKING SCALE

***Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.***

## I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

*Testees should not be penalised for spelling or grammar mistakes in the comprehension section.*

**CHOOSE THE CORRECT OPTION:** (2 pts) 1. The story of a genius

**TRUE / FALSE:** (4 pts)

1. **False.** "He also invented the phonograph, the motion picture camera, and over 1,200 other things." (paragraph 1)
2. **False.** He started experimenting "at a young age with electrical things at home". (paragraph 2)
3. **True.** "When he was 12 years old, he got his first job." (paragraph 3)
4. **True.** "He called himself a 'two-shift man' because he worked 16 out of 24 hours." (paragraph 5)

**ORDER OF EVENTS:** (2 pts)

2. Edison first became a newsboy, then became a telegraph operator, and finally got his patent.

**SENTENCE COMPLETION:** (2 pts)

1. ...setting up a laboratory in a baggage car (in his spare time).
2. ...automatically printing stock prices on a tape.

**PICK OUT PHRASES:** (3 pts)

1. "he attended school for only two months"
2. "his first work experience did not end well"
3. "he thought of his deafness as a blessing in many ways"

**WORD REFERENCE:** (2 pts) 1. Thomas (Edison) 2. (Numerous) inventions